



2 million iPhone 5 sold

Apple has recorded a sales figure of 2 million iPhone 5 in the first weekend of launch in China
<http://dgit.in/ZIKMRu>



Devil May Cry launch date

Devil May Cry creator Capcom has announced that the new version will release on January 25, 2013 as a digital download

Smartphones Test

HOW WE TESTED

We have seen quite a large number of manufacturers tap into the 5-inch smartphone/tablet hybrid space. The price tag of these devices ranges from under ₹10,000 all the way up to ₹37,500. So, to keep things fair, we divided the 13 phablets into three price brackets – up to ₹10,000, ₹10,001 to ₹20,000 and ₹20,001 and above. The street price of the devices was used to place them into the categories and not the MRP's printed on the box.

Since all the phablets run on Android 4.0 or higher, getting them on an even ground to perform the test was simple. We synced our Google account with them and performed the software update. Apart from the pre-installed apps, none of these devices needed any major

update. After the update, we ran a bunch of benchmarks on all the devices to see how the raw hardware performs. This not only helps us in determining the final best performer but also tells us, which of two homogenous products has better raw performance.

After the performance we tested to see how the smartphone works as a multimedia device. For this we played some MP3 songs and a bunch of videos. We didn't install a third party video player, as we wanted to see what formats would play natively on the phablets. We ran HD and SD videos of a variety of formats such as .MOV, .MKV, .AVI, and .MP4.

We also downloaded a few apps and games from the Play Store to see how they would

perform. These are apps you use on a daily basis such as Facebook, Angry Birds Star Wars, Temple Run and more.

We assessed the build quality and comfort of the devices on the basis of materials used, placement of hardware buttons and connectivity options.

Last, but not least, the ability of the phablets to make calls. Yes, the device may be your multimedia, entertainment and work buddy, but above all things it needs to be able to make a phone call and send a text message. We moved around to see how the phablets would perform under various network conditions and also to judge the quality and volume of the voice during the calls.

capacitive buttons to the rear panel and the placement of the camera. You wouldn't recognize that this is a budget phone if you saw it from a distance. On its right, it has the power button and the left has the volume rocker, which are really slim and may be inconvenient to use without looking at them. The phone even comes with a Samsung Galaxy Note style flap

cover. The device feels heavy but is comfortable for use with one hand.

The Zync Cloud Z5 has a design that is very reminiscent of the Samsung Galaxy Note. From the glossy front to the textured back, from a distance it's easy to mistake this device as the first generation Note. Just like the Note, it is very comfortable for single as well as two-hand use. It has the power switch on the left and the volume rocker on the right. These buttons have a slight bulge to them, which makes it easy to identify without looking.

The Micromax Canvas 2 A110 has a Samsung Galaxy Nexus style curved design and it has mimicked this design element quite well. We wish it had copied the slimness of Nexus device too, but the A110 isn't thicker than its peers. It's surprisingly a lot more comfortable to hold than the other devices in this category. The textured back adds to the grip and the bulgy volume rocker and



Intex AQUA



Micromax Canvas 2 A110

The Intex Aqua 5 on the other hand looks like a brick and a bigger version of the Intex Aqua 4. The display has a square design to it rather than the rectangular look we are familiar with. This isn't a bad thing for regular use but makes typing in the landscape mode a bit uncomfortable. It is the lightest phone in its category on paper but in usage it feels heavier. Where other phones have only three buttons below the display – back, home and menu, the Intex Aqua 5 adds the long lost search button, which we have missed on devices. In its overall design however, it is the least comfortable phablet to use.

Features and Performance

So the budget phablets have done quite a good job at mimicking the looks of some premium devices. But do they perform as well?

The Magicon mNote has a stock Android experience and that is a very good thing. On paper, its raw hardware performance is the best in its

power button are way more conveniently placed that the Cloud Z5. At the bottom of the display are the three capacitive navigation buttons. The device isn't the lightest in its class, but it is easy to use with single as well as both hands. It has the best design in this segment though.